

## MATH 20503 Syllabus Fall 2026

**Course Name:** Finite Mathematics

**Textbook:** *Finite Mathematics* by Lial, Greenwell, and Ritchie. 12<sup>th</sup> Edition

**Software:** Microsoft Excel

**Other Requirements:** Turning Technology Clicker

**Recommended Calculator:** TI-84

**Instructor info and office hours:** See Blackboard

**Textbook and Software:** Homework, online quizzes, and tests are accessed through Pearson MyLab Math. An electronic version of the textbook is included within MyLab Math. The cost for MyLab Math will be automatically charged to your university account, allowing you instant access at a reduced price.

**Problems with Software:** If you experience difficulty accessing your MyLab Math course, please consult the “What to do if you have issues with MyLab Math” document available on Blackboard. You may also contact the Pearson Helpline at 888-883-1299 for assistance.

**Communication of Information:** Important course information will be shared throughout the semester. It is your responsibility to read and stay familiar with the information provided in this syllabus, the FAQ document on Blackboard, and all course announcements. Please check your university email daily. Not being aware of posted or emailed information is not an acceptable excuse and may negatively affect your grade. If anything is unclear, contact your instructor promptly.

**Course Entry Quiz:** You must earn a score of 100% on the Course Entry Quiz before you are able to access other assignments in MyLab Math.

**Homework:** For each lesson, there are three homework assignments.

**Intro Exercises:** These introductory assignments consist of videos and practice problems designed that you will complete before class to prepare you for that day’s lesson. Clicker quizzes at the beginning of class will be based on these assignments. Intro Exercises may be completed after the due date for half credit until the final day of class. Two Intro Exercises will be dropped at the end of the semester.

**Learning Exercises:** These assignments provide essential practice with the concepts and skills from each lesson. They are designed to help strengthen your understanding of the material. Learning Exercises may be completed after the due date for half credit until the final day of class. Two Learning Exercises will be dropped at the end of the semester.

**Mastery Exercises:** These assignments provide the additional practice needed to develop a deeper understanding of the material and prepare for success on quizzes and tests. Mastery Exercises are not worth points, but they are an important part of the course and students who wish to do well in the class should plan to complete them.

**Clicker Quiz:** The clicker quiz consists of questions distributed across the entire semester and recorded as a single quiz grade. Typically, several questions will be answered at the beginning of class using your clicker, with additional questions sometimes asked at the end of class or during group work days. Points are awarded for correct answers, not participation. You must be physically present in the classroom and have a PointSolutions clicker to receive credit. All points earned throughout the semester are totaled into one clicker quiz grade.

**Attendance:** Students are expected to attend all class meetings. We recognize, however, that unexpected circumstances may occasionally prevent attendance. Rather than requiring documentation for absences, a reasonable number of clicker quiz points are dropped for all students to account for missed classes. Should you have to miss an unusually high number of days, please contact your instructor as early as possible.

**Online Quizzes:** There are nine graded online quizzes completed outside of class using MyLab Math and one quiz administered in the testing center. The testing center quiz allows one attempt and follows the test schedule listed below. For the remaining nine quizzes, you will have three attempts, and your highest score will count. Online Quizzes may be completed after the due date for half credit until the final day of class. At least one online quiz will be dropped at the end of the semester.

**Projects:** This course includes three in-class group projects. Attendance and participation are required on project days. If you must miss class on a project day, contact your instructor as soon as possible. These projects are designed to reinforce and apply the material from each chapter. Additional details will be provided closer to each project date.

**Practice Tests:** Practice tests are provided as study tools and do not count toward your grade. You may complete them as many times as you wish.

**Testing:** There are four tests, each worth 100 points. To be eligible to take a test, you must complete all associated Intro Exercises and Learning Exercises with a score of at least 50%. Each test has a 75-minute time limit. While the exam is designed to take approximately 50 minutes, additional time is included to accommodate answer entry and potential technical issues. If technical difficulties last less than 15 minutes, no extra time will be granted. If issues exceed 15 minutes, you will be given further instructions.

All tests and the final exam will be taken at the MRTC Testing Center (CHPN 327) on the scheduled dates listed below. Any changes to the schedule will be communicated via email. The testing center operates on a first-come, first-served basis with limited computers. **A valid university-issued ID is required.** Only testing center–provided calculators and scratch paper may be used. Students should bring their own writing instruments.

Students are not permitted to have personal belongings – other than a student ID and writing instruments – during tests. Prohibited items include cell phones, smart watches, notes, and similar materials. Possession of unauthorized items, even if not used, will result in a score of zero and may be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

**Make-Up Tests:** If you miss a test, please contact your instructor as soon as possible. Some tests may be able to be made up immediately. Students who miss a test or wish to retake a test will have two make-up opportunities during the semester.

- Midterm Make-up Day: Students may take or retake either Test #1 or Test #2. Only one test may be taken on this day. If a test is retaken, the higher score will count toward the final grade.
- End-of-Term Make-up Day: Students may take or retake any one of the four tests, even if they already used the Midterm Make-up Day. Only one test may be taken on this day. If a test is retaken, the new score will count toward the final grade.

Note: Scores of zero resulting from academic dishonesty or testing center policy violations cannot be replaced.

**Test Scheduling:** Tests must be taken on the dates listed below. Exceptions are made only under very limited circumstances. If you know in advance that you will be unable to take a test as scheduled, notify your instructor as soon as possible. Tests will not be rescheduled for reasons within a student's control, such as work or travel.

| Testing Groups | Group 1                     | Group 2                     | Group 3                      |
|----------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
|                | 001 MWF 8:35 AM - 9:25 AM   | 003 MWF 4:10 PM - 5:00 PM   | 007 TuTh 12:30 PM - 1:45 PM  |
|                | 002 MWF 11:50 AM - 12:40 PM | 005 MWF 3:05 PM - 3:55 PM   | 008 TuTh 2:00 PM - 3:15 PM   |
|                | 004 MWF 12:55 PM - 1:45 PM  | 006 MWF 2:00 PM - 2:50 PM   | 009 TuTh 9:30 AM - 10:45 AM  |
|                | 013 MWF 11:50 AM - 12:40 PM | 011 TuTh 3:30 PM - 4:45 PM  | 010 TuTh 8:00 AM - 9:15 AM   |
|                | 014 MWF 9:40 AM - 10:30 AM  | 017 TuTh 12:30 PM - 1:45 PM | 012 TuTh 11:00 AM - 12:15 PM |
|                | 015 MWF 3:05 PM - 3:55 PM   | 020 TuTh 2:00 PM - 3:15 PM  | 018 TuTh 8:00 AM - 9:15 AM   |
|                | 016 MWF 2:00 PM - 2:50 PM   |                             | 019 TuTh 11:00 AM - 12:15 PM |

|                     | Test Schedule |              |             |
|---------------------|---------------|--------------|-------------|
|                     | Group 1       | Group 2      | Group 3     |
| Quiz #1             | 8/24-8/25     | 8/25-8/26    | 8/26-8/27   |
| Test #1             | 9/14 – 9/15   | 9/15 – 9/16  | 9/16 – 9/17 |
| Test #2             | 10/6 – 10/7   | 10/7 – 10/8  | 10/8 – 10/9 |
| Mid-term Make-up    | 10/12-10/14   | 10/12-10/14  | 10/12-10/14 |
| Test #3             | 11/2 – 11/3   | 11/3 – 11/4  | 11/4 – 11/5 |
| Test #4             | 11/23, 11/30  | 11/30 – 12/1 | 12/1 – 12/2 |
| End-of-term Make-up | 12/3          | 12/3         | 12/3        |
| Final Exam          | 12/6, 12/10   | 12/6, 12/10  | 12/6, 12/10 |

**Final Exam:** The final exam is a comprehensive exam and required. You will have 100 minutes to complete the exam.

**Determination of grades:**

| Assignment         | #  | Points Each | Point Total |
|--------------------|----|-------------|-------------|
| Intro Exercises    | 20 | 4           | 80          |
| Learning Exercises | 20 | 4           | 80          |
| Mastery Exercises  | 20 | 0           | 0           |
| Online Quizzes     | 10 | 4           | 40          |
| Tests              | 4  | 100         | 400         |
| Participation      |    |             |             |
| Clicker Quiz       | 1  | 120         | 120         |
| Regression Project | 1  | 20          | 20          |
| Finance Project    | 1  | 30          | 30          |
| Statistics Project | 1  | 30          | 30          |
| Final Exam         | 1  | 200         | 200         |
| Total              |    |             | 1000        |

**Note:** Grades displayed in the MyLab Gradebook are shown as a weighted average using all course assignments, including those not yet completed.

**Grading Scale:** The final letter grade is based on the following percentage scale:

A = 90%-100%; B = 80%-89%; C = 70%-79%; D = 60%-69%; F = 0-59%

**Calculator Policy:** If you miss a test, please contact your instructor as soon as possible. During computer-based tests, you will be provided with a TI-84 Plus CE calculator by the testing center. Personal calculators are not permitted. You are expected to be comfortable using this calculator, as proctors cannot provide assistance with calculator operation. Using a TI-84 for homework and quizzes is strongly recommended.

**Academic Honesty Policy:** As a core part of its mission, the University of Arkansas provides students with the opportunity to further their educational goals through programs of study and research in an environment that promotes freedom of inquiry and academic responsibility. Accomplishing this mission is only possible when intellectual honesty and individual integrity prevail. Each University of Arkansas student is required to be familiar with and abide by the University's Academic Integrity Policy which may be found at <http://honesty.uark.edu/>. Students with questions about how these policies apply to a particular course or assignment should immediately contact their instructor.

Students must be physically present in the classroom to earn points for the clicker quiz. An attempt to earn points while not physically present in the classroom is considered academic dishonesty. This includes, but is not limited to, clicking in for another student or asking/allowing another student to click in for you for any reason. If any such event occurs for any clicker quiz question, it will be reported as an Academic Integrity violation and may result, at a minimum, in a zero on the entire clicker quiz.

**AI Policy:** Students may use AI on homework assignments and at-home quizzes; however, I strongly recommend using it thoughtfully and treating it as you would a tutor. Use AI to ask questions, clarify concepts, get additional explanations, or help you understand a process. You should not use AI do the work for you.

The purpose of homework and quizzes is to give you the practice necessary to learn the material. In past semesters, students who relied on AI to complete their work rather than using it as a tool for learning have had very low rates of success in the course. **AI can help you learn the mathematics, but it cannot replace learning the mathematics.**

**Accessibility:** Under University Policy and federal and state law, students with documented disabilities are entitled to reasonable accommodations to ensure the student has an equal opportunity to perform in class. If any member of the class has such a disability and needs special academic accommodations, you can request services from the Center for Educational Access (CEA) at <http://cea.uark.edu>. Reasonable accommodations may be arranged after CEA has verified your disability. Do not hesitate to contact your teacher or the course coordinator if any assistance is need in this process. Students eligible for accommodations will receive an email from the coordinator with a list of set-up accommodations and a request to schedule a meeting to set up other accommodations if necessary. **If a meeting is requested, students must meet with the coordinator at least one week in advance to set up and discuss accommodations.** Extensions to allow for time to set up accommodations are not granted.

**University Sponsored Event Absences:** Students who must miss a test for a university sponsored event must alert their instructor and the course coordinator (Brian Rickard, [brickar@uark.edu](mailto:brickar@uark.edu)) at least one week prior to leaving town or missing the test, whichever comes first. As quizzes and homework are completed online and open in advance, students are expected to complete these assignments on time. If you will only miss a few days due to university sponsored events, the general attendance policy will apply. If you will miss more than a few days, please contact your instructor. Keep track of all class dates missed and the reason.

**Recording of Class Lectures:** By attending this class, the student understands the course may be recorded and consents to being recorded for official university educational purposes. Be aware that incidental recording may also occur before and after official class times.

**Inclement Weather Policy:** If the university closes due to inclement weather, in-person classes will not be held. Instructors may hold class virtually or choose to make up missed class time using recorded lectures, assignments, etc. Students should monitor their email for instructions from their instructor.

**Note:** We reserve the right to make changes to the syllabus during the semester. If changes are made, you will be notified of the changes by email.